VERIDIAN PHARMA LTD. — Quality & Compliance Directorate, Hyderabad Facility

Standard Operating Procedure: Deviation Reporting and Management

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Owner: Meera Rao (QA Head)	**Department:** Quality Assurance	**Status:** Superseded

1. Purpose

This standard operating procedure establishes the mandatory requirements for identifying, recording, evaluating, and documenting operational and quality deviations across all active operational sectors at the Hyderabad manufacturing site of Veridian Pharma Ltd.

The primary objective is to maintain strict adherence to current Good Manufacturing Practices (cGMP), ensure early detection of unpredicted events, facilitate comprehensive technical investigations, and enforce timely corrective and preventive measures to safeguard product safety, purity, and efficacy.

A well-governed deviation reporting mechanism enables systematic trend evaluation, root cause identification, and institutional continuous improvement while satisfying global health authority expectations.

2. Scope

This procedure applies universally to all personnel engaged in cGMP activities, including primary manufacturing, secondary packaging, quality control testing, warehousing, materials management, utilities engineering, and qualified facility maintenance at the Hyderabad facility.

The scope encompasses deviations arising during routine batch execution, environmental monitoring excursions, utility interruptions, packaging anomalies, automated system faults, and procedural departures during in-process inspections.

Contract service providers, technical vendors, and temporary engineering staff operating within regulated areas are strictly obligated to report deviations in accordance with this document.

3. Responsibilities

• **All Operational Personnel:** Recognize deviations immediately upon occurrence, halt unsafe or uncontrolled processing, implement initial containment, and complete timely notification.

• **Area Supervisors & Shift In-Charge:** Verify the accuracy of reported events, assess initial material quarantine, countersign notifications, and initiate preliminary fact-gathering.

• **Quality Assurance Reviewer:** Classify deviations according to established risk ranking, assign unique tracking identifiers, log events in the central deviation register, and guide technical root cause analysis.

• **QA Head (Meera Rao):** Review critical deviation escalations, provide overall executive governance over Quality Management System dossiers, and approve final closure dossiers.

4. Procedure

4.1 Immediate Identification and Recognition: Any unexpected event, unplanned excursion, or departure from approved procedures must be recognized immediately by operational personnel during the execution of daily manufacturing, laboratory, or warehousing duties.

4.2 Material Containment and Quarantine: The executing analyst or operator must take immediate containment action to secure affected product lots or materials to eliminate any possibility of continued unauthorized processing, inadvertent distribution, or cross-contamination.

4.3 Reporting Timeline: Deviations must be reported within 24 hours of discovery.

4.4 Formal QMS Transmission: Reported to QA via the QMS form DEV-01.

4.5 System Logging and Registration: The QA reviewer logs the deviation into the central deviation register and assigns a tracking identification code to ensure end-to-end traceability across subsequent review phases.

4.6 Data Compilation and Operational Review: The initiating department compiles relevant operational logs and environment logs to establish a factual, chronologically structured summary of manufacturing conditions leading up to the excursion.

4.7 Quality Impact Assessment: Quality Assurance conducts an initial risk assessment to determine potential product quality impact on concurrent and historically released batches.

4.8 Investigation Team Formation: A formal deviation investigation team is assigned by the department head to complete root cause analysis utilizing structured methodologies such as 5-Whys and Ishikawa fishbone diagrams.

4.9 Root Cause Determination: The designated investigation team performs thorough technical evaluations, interviews operating personnel, and examines maintenance calibration histories to pinpoint the underlying systemic breakdown.

4.10 CAPA Development and Approval: Corrective and preventive action plans are developed in conjunction with functional managers to eradicate identified failure modes and prevent recurrence.

4.11 Dossier Compilation and Final Archiving: Following verification of completed actions, Quality Assurance reviews the complete investigation record, verifies batch disposition recommendations, and archives the closed file in accordance with document governance rules.

5. Records and Documentation

All deviation records, Form DEV-01 originals, immediate containment logs, equipment data historian printouts, and completed investigation reports must be archived in the central QMS electronic file system.

Records must be retained in accordance with the corporate retention policy, ensuring instant availability during regulatory inspections and internal corporate quality audits.

6. Revision History

Version	Effective Date	Change Description
1.0	2026-03-10	Initial release of standardized deviation reporting procedure.